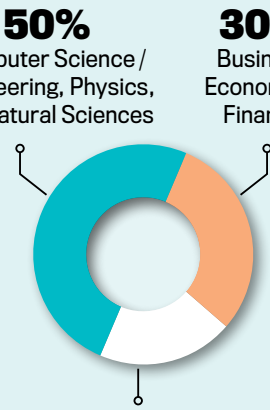
MOST POPULAR COURSES

- **STEM fields** are still the most popular given explosion of technology, the tremendous job opportunities and the STEM OPT visa programme, under which foreign students can extend their work authorisation for an extra year
- Increasing awareness of environmental and sustainable development has led to a rise in interest in **Earth, Environmental and Atmospheric Sciences**
- Specialised courses as varied as **Aerospace Engineering and Art History** also find favour



COST OF FOREIGN EDUCATION



IN THE US

$40,000-$55,000
(Rs 33 lakh-Rs 45 lakh)
Annual fee for a 4-year bachelor degree in a public or a private non-profit college

IN THE UK

£22,000
(Rs 23 lakh)
Annual fee for a three-year undergraduate degree

IN CANADA

CAD 20,000-35,000
(Rs 12.4 lakh-Rs 21.7 lakh)
Annual fee for **undergraduate programmes**

IN AUSTRALIA

AUD 20,000-40,000
(Rs 11 lakh-Rs 22 lakh)
Annual fee for a typical three-year undergraduate degree

Note: All figures are indicative, and may vary from university to university

Sources: Yocket, Foreign Admits, Athena, Statistics Canada

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

students studying on American campuses compared to Indians between 2020-21 and 2021-22. If the number of Indian students went up by 18.9 per cent—from 167,582 to 199,982—in that period, those from China saw a decline of 8.6 per cent—from 317,299 to 290,086. Likewise, an immigration statistics report released by the UK in September 2022 revealed that 127,731 visas were issued to Indian students in 2021 compared to 116,476 issued to students of Chinese nationality.

The smorgasbord of choices is what a majority of the students cite as the reason they look abroad for higher education. There are other reasons besides. The failure of the education system back home to keep up with Gen Z's aspirations is one, the phenomenon of too many students chasing too few seats in Indian colleges another. By contrast, there is an endless glimmer of opportunity in the parallel universe that is an international university—a sprawling campus with world-class faculty and facilities, flexible and well-designed curriculums, abundant research openings, a chance to interact with another culture and people and, at the end of it all, perhaps a career that gets you a permanent place among the global professional elite. As Pratibha Jain, 27, from



"OUR EDUCATION SYSTEM DOES NOT DELIVER WHAT IT SHOULD DESPITE ALL EFFORT. THERE IS A LACK OF PRACTICAL KNOWLEDGE AT UNDERGRADUATE LEVELS"

– DINESH SINGH
Chancellor, K.R. Mangalam University, Gurugram